

After you have installed the latest version of the SEPCS and the Update Service utility, restart your computer once. Then just click on the Update Service shortcut on your Desktop and follow the instructions provided on-screen. You need to have Internet Explorer 5 or later and Flash Player 7 or later installed to be able to see the on-screen instructions.

Most new Sony Ericsson phones have updateable firmware, and the general procedure is as follows.

1. Turn off your phone, and remove the battery and the SIM card. Replace the battery (without the SIM card).
2. Start the SE Update Service. It should ask you to agree to a few terms and conditions, and remind you to make sure that you are connected to the Internet and have a full charge on your phone.
3. Keep the [C] button ([Clear]) on your phone pressed (or whatever button the Update Service asks you to), and then connect the phone to the PC via the USB cable. Keep [C] pressed until the Update Service tells you to let go.
4. If you get a "Found New Hardware..." message from Windows (a device called "USB Flash" may be found), let it search automatically online for drivers. After the USB Flash drivers are loaded, disconnect your phone, switch it off again, then hold down [C] and reconnect it to the PC.
5. When the Update Service tells you to let go of [C], do so. Click Next and follow the on-screen instructions.
6. As usual, make sure you don't trip over any cables and cause the phone to disconnect from the PC, or switch off the power. Don't touch the phone till the Update Service tells you to disconnect your phone.

As you can see, firmware flashes have become quite simple, thanks to good software and support from most major manufacturers. However, enough of the branded software; let's take a look at an open source mobile management software that will really let you tinker with your phone.